

Sudhakar Vuppalapati

Engineering Manager | AI-Forward Engineering Leadership | 18+ Years

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 18 years spanning hands-on software architecture, product ownership, and team management across global organisations. Proven ability to build and mentor high-performing engineering teams, manage full SDLC, and align technical delivery with business goals. Now actively expanding into Generative AI — exploring agentic workflows, Claude Code, MCP servers, and AI-assisted engineering practices to lead teams in the AI-native development era. Experienced Scrum Master and Product Owner with cross-cultural communication skills.

AI LEADERSHIP & EMERGING TECHNOLOGY

Proactively investing in Generative AI leadership capability — exploring agentic AI workflows, AI-assisted developer tooling (Claude Code), and LLM integration patterns to guide engineering teams in adopting AI-native development practices.

AI Orchestration (Agentic)	Claude Code CLI	MCP Server Integration
LLM API Integration	GitHub Actions CI/CD	Azure DevOps Pipelines
Spring Boot + AI APIs	Prompt Engineering	Event-Driven AI Workflows

- Actively learning **Generative AI engineering** with Anthropic Claude — understanding agentic architectures, tool-use APIs, and multi-agent orchestration to guide engineering teams.
- Explored **Claude Code CLI** for AI-assisted development workflows, evaluating its impact on engineering productivity, code quality, and developer onboarding speed.
- Investigated **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** as an emerging standard for connecting LLMs to internal tools and services — assessing adoption pathways for platform engineering teams.
- Hands-on with **GitHub Actions on Azure** for automating AI microservice deployments — building reusable workflow templates applicable across engineering teams.
- Evaluating AI-native development practices to define team standards, tooling guidelines, and responsible AI adoption frameworks for engineering organisations.

LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES

Team Building & Mentoring	Agile / Scrum Master	Product Ownership & Roadmap
Cross-Functional Collaboration	Stakeholder Management	Delivery & Risk Management
Technical Strategy & Vision	Budget & Resource Planning	Vendor & Partner Management
SDLC & DevOps Practices	Hiring & Performance Reviews	Cross-Cultural Communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Architect & Engineering Lead

Cognizant Technology Solutions | Feb 2025 – Present

- Lead a cross-functional team delivering a cloud-native AWS SFTP ingestion and event-processing platform.
- Drive engineering standards, code reviews, and CI/CD best practices using Azure DevOps pipelines.

- Champion IaC adoption (CloudFormation) and AI-assisted development tooling across the engineering team.
- Partner with business stakeholders to translate requirements into prioritised technical deliverables.

Technical Architect

Delta Airlines | Oct 2023 – Jul 2024

- Acted as technical liaison between business analysts, product teams, and engineering.
- Directed design of real-time duplicate booking detection (AWS MSK + Step Functions), improving data reliability.
- Guided engineering decisions on AWS managed services vs custom solutions for cost and scale optimisation.

Principal Architect — Team Lead

HERE Technologies | Aug 2021 – Oct 2023

- Led architecture and engineering delivery for Automotive OEM clients (VINFAST, Toyota) across EU ISA compliance.
- Coordinated multi-disciplinary teams across C++, Java, and cloud engineering workstreams.
- Managed Toyota MM21 on-premises to AWS EKS migration — stakeholder alignment, timelines, and delivery.
- Mentored engineers on cloud platform adoption, REST API design, and software craftsmanship.

Technical Manager

Infosys | Feb 2013 – Apr 2021

- Managed complete SDLC for multiple product streams (Video Analytics, In-Memory SQL Engine, Location Services, Telematics Platform) from requirements to production.
- Led Agile ceremonies as Scrum Master; facilitated sprint planning, retrospectives, and backlog grooming.
- Hired, onboarded, and grew engineering teams; conducted performance reviews and defined career development plans.
- Collaborated with global product owners at LexisNexis, AGCO, and First Group America.
- Filed US Patent Application No. 17/513,597 — led the full innovation-to-IP process.
- Managed vendor integrations across Device Insight, Agrolink, and AGCO platforms.

Staff System Software Engineer — Product Owner

IBM India Software Labs | Apr 2011 – Feb 2013

- Product Owner for Asterix IBM POWER virtualisation tool — defined backlog, accepted stories, and coordinated across hardware and software engineering teams.
- Aligned IBM HMC product roadmap with hardware server development cycles across distributed teams.

R&D; Engineer

Nokia India Pvt Ltd | May 2007 – Mar 2011

- Delivered Nokia S60 Symbian Java runtime JSR specs as part of an R&D; team.
- Took full ownership of individual JSR modules end-to-end in collaboration with international teams.

Technical Lead

Tech Mahindra Ltd | Sep 2006 – May 2007

- Led a development team — responsible for technical guidance, code quality, and on-time delivery.

KEY MANAGEMENT HIGHLIGHTS

- Led engineering delivery across 8+ client engagements simultaneously at Infosys spanning Retail, Automotive, and Insurance.
- Served as Scrum Master and Product Owner simultaneously — bridging product vision and engineering execution.
- Mentored engineers from junior to senior level; introduced Agile and DevOps practices to non-cloud-native teams.
- Coordinated cross-cultural teams across India, Europe, and the US at Nokia, HERE Technologies, and Infosys.
- Delivered US patent filing (App. No. 17/513,597) by leading the full innovation-to-IP process within an engineering team.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Scrum Master (CSM) — Scrum Alliance
- Introduction to People Management — IIM Bangalore Executive Programme
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03)
- HiveMQ MQTT Associate Certification
- Sun Certified Java Programmer (SCJP 1.5) & Mobile Application Developer (SCMAD 1.0)

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

Java / Spring Boot / Scala | AWS (EKS, ECS Fargate, MSK, Kinesis, Step Functions, CloudFormation) | Apache Kafka / Flink | Docker / Kubernetes | Anthropic Claude API / MCP / Claude Code | GitHub Actions / Azure DevOps | Agile / Scrum

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Computer Science & Information Technology

G. PullaReddy Engineering College, Kurnool | Sri Krishnadevaraya University